

Unit 13 An Encounter with the Coast Guard

Read & Listen: Trespassing in a Restricted Area

Exercise 1

After the <incident> with the injured motorman and the rescue operation Captain James leaves the bridge, and goes to his cabin to get some sleep. Timo Ranta, the Second Mate remains <in charge> on the navigation bridge. After a few hours the weather conditions start to change and <visibility> is greatly reduced by fog. Timo gives orders to reduce speed and the Marina proceeds on its route. When the vessel is approaching the area south of Helsinki the instruments on the bridge start to behave in a strange way.

The automatic steering system, the <autopilot>, is no longer working properly, and suddenly the picture on the radar <screen> breaks down as well. Timo Ranta, who lacks Captains James' <experience> at sea, finds himself in <trouble>. Due to a <navigational error> on his part the Marina gets <off course>.

Exercise 2

Then suddenly there is a complete breakdown, a so-called <blackout> in the ship's power system and the Marina starts drifting with strong southerly wind directly towards the <restricted> area southeast of Helsinki.

Marina's <manoeuvre> has not gone <unnoticed>. It is 4 o'clock a.m. at Coast Guard station. Lieutenant Mustasaari is on duty and notices an <unknown vessel> on the radar screen, heading away from the main fairway towards the restricted area southeast of the station.

Exercise 3

As Lieutenant Mustasaari boards the Marina, he is met by Timo Ranta the Second Mate.

- Good morning. We are from the <Finnish Coast Guard>. I would like to speak to your Captain immediately.
- Certainly. Come this way, please.

- Mustasaari follows Timo Ranta to the navigation bridge, where Captain James is waiting.
- Good morning, I'm Captain James, what **<can I do for you>**? What is the **<reason>** for your visit?
 - Good morning, I'm Lieutenant Petteri Mustasaari from the Finnish Coast Guard vessel. I'm afraid I will have to ask you some questions. Your ship has **<deviated>** from the main fairway and you are now in a so-called restricted area.
 - Indeed, I had no idea, says Captain James. We had a black-out just now but the power is working again. I realised we were off course. I was relieved that we didn't **<run aground>**. What seems **<to be the problem>**? This is not a military area, as far as I understand.
 - No, it isn't. But in a restricted area **<foreign vessels>** can pass only by the main fairway. And it is **<prohibited>** to anchor, without a special reason or a **<permit>**. May I see your **<identification papers>**, please?
 - Yes, **<here you are>**.
 - What is your **<port of destination>**?
 - It is Kotka.
 - What is your **<port of departure>**?
 - Santander in Spain, with **<ports of call>** on the route. Our last port was Riga in Latvia.
 - And what is the **<purpose>** of your visit?
 - I am on my way to unload a cargo in the port of Kotka.

Exercise 4

- I'm afraid sir I will have to compile an official report on this. You have not been **<complying with>** the regulations. You said that you are on your way to Kotka. Why are you not in the main fairway? You are rather far **<off the route>**. How do you explain this fact?
- Well, one of our crew members was very badly injured. He was picked up by helicopter in position 59° 40' North and 024° 00' East. After that weather conditions became worse. There was a breakdown in our **<power system>** when the vessel was passing south of Helsinki Lighthouse. I myself was not on the bridge at the time. Our navigational equipment did not **<work properly>**, and there must have been a **<navigational error>** of some kind. But then visibility is very bad, there is a **<thick fog>**.

- Yes, that's right. Can you show me the <logbook>? Thank you. Did you send distress signals when your man was injured? Ah, yes here it is. You <signalled> on channel 16 and the helicopter arrived.
- Yes. It carried our man to hospital for treatment.
- Can I have a look at the <Muster Roll>, please? Mmm, I can see that one of your crew members is <signing off> in Kotka. He is of Algerian nationality.
- Yes, he is <signing on> to a German vessel in Kotka a few days after our arrival.
- I see. Has he got a visa?
- No, he doesn't.
- He needs a <transit visa> for Finland in this case. You should <notify> the Frontier Guard authorities on arrival and they may <grant> him a transit visa.
- All right. I will do that.
- Fine. This completes my interrogation. Would you mind <signing this form>, please. It will of course have to be passed through the official channels.
- Yes, of course.
- And we will now <escort> you away from this area back to the fairway. Please follow the Coast guard vessel.
- All right, yes, that is most welcome. These are <dangerous> waters.
- Yes, indeed – you were lucky not to run aground or to <collide with> another vessel. This is an area with great traffic density!
- Well, goodbye, and thank you for your help. Sorry about the <inconvenience> we have caused.
- No serious harm done. These things happen, Captain. Goodbye, and have a safe voyage!

Exercise 5

You are <approaching> a prohibited fishing area.

Is <shore-based> radar assistance available?

Anchoring is <prohibited>.

You are running into danger. <Shallow water> ahead of you.

You are <obstructing> the fairway.

You are not <complying> with traffic regulations.

Your <navigation lights> are not visible.

Small <fishing boats> in area around south of Utö. Navigate <with caution>.

The Interrogation Record

Exercise 1

1. Moving or being in a place without due permission is called **<trespassing>**.
2. Activities that are against the law are illegal or **<illicit>**.
3. A sea area where foreign vessels are forbidden to anchor, or deviate from the main fairway is called a **<restricted area>**.
4. Waters belonging to a particular nation are called **<territorial waters>**.
5. The "home port" of a vessel is its **<port of registry>**.
6. The Marina **<deviated/departed>** from its main course because of a **<navigational>** error.
7. Lt. Mustasaari drew a map **<overlay>** of the incident.
8. Captain James had to write his name or his **<signature>** on the **<interrogation>** record.
9. The incident will be **<reported/passed>** through **<official>** channels to the authorities.
10. Another word for sea border is sea **<boundary>**.
11. The place where a person lives is his **<domicile>**.

Important Structures: Polite Phrases

Exercise 1

1. I **<would like>** to speak to your Captain immediately.
2. Certainly, come **<this way, please>**.
3. Good morning, I'm Captain James. What can I **<do for you>**?
4. What seems **<to be the problem>**?
5. Can you **<show me>** the Muster Roll, **<please>**?
6. Yes, **<of course>**.
7. I'm **<afraid>** I have to compile an official report.
8. **<Please>** show me your identification papers.
9. Here **<you are>**.
10. **<Sorry about>** the inconvenience we have caused.
11. **<These things>** happen. No serious **<harm>** done.